policymakers thus take the long view, focusing on developing India's capabilities and coordination with major powers in Asia such as the United States and Japan in order to manage, or prevent if possible, crises on the horizon. In the context of this volume, this approach can be described as one of extensive hedging, whereby India avoids leaning too far in the direction of either confrontation or cooperation when it comes to China, yet New Delhi is aware of the need to develop its capabilities and strategic partnerships for the long term. Thus, India seeks to strengthen its alignment with Japan without going too far in the direction of antagonising China or making military commitments to Japan.

Naturally, Japan's priorities are also a factor in India's calculus. As discussed previously, Tokyo's deteriorating security environment has driven its more nationalist leaders such as Abe to seek partnerships with other democratic states in Asia as a potential counterweight to China. At the current level of bilateral relations, India and Japan do not pose a credible military threat to China. However, the primary advantage of the relationship is diplomatic. In other words, Japan seeks a *political* commitment from India to employ whatever diplomatic tools are available to constrain future manifestations of Chinese aggression. Japan obtains this commitment from India by building policy interdependence between the two countries.

## *Investing in India's economic and military capabilities*

At the core of the relationship lies an implicit bargain whereby Japan undertakes to assist in India's developmental efforts while India agrees to engage in security cooperation and place its diplomatic weight in Japan's corner with regard